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THE LOCAL BUSINESS ONLINE PRESENCE AUDIT

Find out exactly why customers can't find you
and what to fix first

BEFORE YOU START

This guide walks you through a complete audit of your business's online presence. You can work through it in an afternoon.

By the end you will know:
- Where you are invisible to customers who are actively searching for you
- What your competitors are doing that you are not
- Exactly what to fix, in what order

No technical knowledge needed. No paid tools required. Everything in this guide is free to check.

Set aside two hours. Get a notepad. Let's go.

01

Google Business Profile

Your Google Business Profile (GBP) is the single most important free tool available to a local business. It appears when someone searches for your business name, or searches for what you do in your area.

Most profiles are incomplete, out of date, or actively sending customers elsewhere.

Find your profile: Search your business name on Google. If nothing appears, your profile is either unclaimed or does not exist — this is your first priority.

Quick check: Search your business name on Google right now. Does a profile appear on the right side of the results?

1.1 Basic Information

Check	Status
Business name is correct and consistent with your website	
Address is accurate	
Phone number is correct	
Website URL is linked	
Business category is correct	
Opening hours are accurate and up to date	
Special hours set for bank holidays	

1.2 Photos

Check	Status
At least 10 photos uploaded	
Photos include: exterior, interior, team, products or services	
Photos are recent (within the last 12 months)	
Photos are high quality — not blurry or poorly lit	
Cover photo and logo are set	

Benchmark: Check your top 3 local competitors. How many photos do they have? That is the minimum you need to compete.

1.3 Reviews

Check	Status
You have a Google review link to send customers	
You have responded to every review	
Your average rating is 4.0 or above	
You have received a review in the last 60 days	
Your review count is competitive with local rivals	

My reviews: _____ Competitor reviews: _____

1.4 Posts and Updates

Check	Status
You have posted an update in the last 30 days	
You have an active offer or promotion showing	
Your description mentions your location and key services	

02

Your Website

Your website does not need to be beautiful. It needs to be fast, readable by Google, and clear about what you do and where you are.

Most local business websites fail on at least two of those three.

Quick check: Go to pagespeed.web.dev and enter your website URL. Run the test on mobile. Write your score here: _____

2.1 Speed and Mobile

Check	Status
Mobile performance score is 70 or above	
Desktop performance score is 80 or above	
Website loads in under 3 seconds on mobile	
Website looks correct on a mobile phone	
Text is readable without zooming in	
Buttons and links are easy to tap on mobile	

2.2 Basic SEO

Check	Status
Page title includes your main service and location	
Meta description is written and under 160 characters	
Your town or city is mentioned on the homepage	
You have an H1 heading on each page	
Your website has SSL (URL starts with https://)	
You have Google Search Console set up	

2.3 Contact and Trust

Check	Status
Phone number is visible on every page	
Contact form works correctly	
Physical address is on the website	
You have an About page with a real photo	
You have testimonials or reviews on the site	
Your social media links are in the header or footer	

03

Social Media

You do not need to be on every platform. You need to be consistent on the right ones.

Right means where your customers actually spend time. A restaurant should be on Instagram and Facebook. A B2B accountant should be on LinkedIn.

Quick check: Where do your customers actually spend time?

_____

3.1 Profile Completeness

Check	Status
Profile photo is your logo or professional headshot	
Cover image is branded and current	
Bio/About section is complete	
Website URL is linked	
Business category is set	
Contact details are visible	

Run this check on every platform where you have an account.

3.2 Activity and Consistency

Check	Status
You have posted on your main platform in the last 14 days	
Your posting is consistent — no long unexplained gaps	
You respond to comments and messages within 24 hours	
Your content is relevant to your customers	
Your tone and visuals are consistent across posts	

04

Reviews and Reputation

Your online reputation is what strangers see before they decide to trust you. Most businesses do nothing to manage it.

4.1 Review Presence

Check
You have claimed your Google Business Profile
You have claimed your Facebook page
You are listed on relevant industry directories
Your reviews are consistent across platforms
You have a process for asking customers for reviews

05

Competitor Comparison

You do not compete against every business in your industry.
You compete against the top 3-5 results that appear when a local customer searches for what you do.

Search Google for your main service and your town.
Write down the top 3 businesses that appear in the map results.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

5.2 Competitor Comparison Table

Check	You	Competitor 1	Competitor 2	Competitor 3
Google review count				
Average rating				
GBP photo count				
Website mobile score				
Last social post				

Where are you behind? _____

Where are you ahead? _____

Quickest win? _____

06

Your Ranked Action Plan

The mistake most business owners make is trying to fix everything at once and fixing nothing properly.

Use your scores from each section. Prioritise the lowest scores first.

Priority 1 — Fix within 2 weeks

Action	Section

06

Your Ranked Action Plan Continued

Priority 2 — Fix within 30 days

Action	Section

Priority 3 — Fix within 90 days

Action	Section

Want this done for you?

I run a full online presence audit for local businesses.

You get a personalised report, a ranked action plan, and a walkthrough video of your findings.

Normal price: £149
Right now: £75

jonathanodriscoll.com/get-audit